Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Analysing curated spaces and audience impact

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do curatorial choices — scale, lighting angle, sightlines, and framing — shape audience meaning in an exhibition?

Arrival check

Watch what happens when we shine a torch flat onto the front of a relief panel vs shining it low across the side ('raking light'). What changes?

[ ] Flat front light washes out the shadows, while low side raking light makes every girder and rivet cast dramatic 3D shadows!

[ ] The lighting angle completely changes the mood and perceived depth of the structure

[ ] Curators design lighting, spacing, and sightlines just as carefully as artists design the panel

Starter visual cues

Lever 1 (Raking vs Ambient light): Low-angle side or top-left lighting maximizes relief shadow contrast.

Lever 2 (Sightline & Breathing space): Eye-level horizon line (145-150 cm) with generous void margins between works.

Lever 3 (Spatial grouping): Sequencing panels from macro structural spans to close-up surface studies.

Lever 4 (Interpretation): Concise wall text connecting site geometry and studio fabrication.

Vote: Why is 'raking light' (light shone from a shallow side or top angle) essential when exhibiting textured collagraphs and structural reliefs?

Studio practice planner

Configure your lighting angle, patina enhancement, and curatorial layout.

Shapes/Focus: Light: 25° top-left raking beam, Light: Side grazing spotlight, Light: Dual cross-angled LEDs, Light: High contrast gallery spot

Tools/Methods: Patina: Chrome top-flange skim, Patina: Deep charcoal undercut, Patina: Warm copper ridge glint, Patina: Matte slate void ground

Exit ticket

Why does 'raking light' (shone at a shallow angle across the surface) make a relief panel look far more dramatic than flat front lighting?

[ ] It catches the raised ridges brightly while casting crisp, elongated shadows across the recessed planes

[ ] It makes the card change colour

[ ] It hides all the surface bumps